

# History Battlefield Tour

## Ypres & The Salient



*Meoncross School – Battlefield Tour*

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**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Tutor Group:** \_\_\_\_\_

# Pre-Trip Information

## What to Pack & Logistics

### What to Pack: The Essential Checklist

Please ensure all pupils have the following items packed in a suitable overnight bag (no hard suitcases if possible, to maximize coach storage space):

- **Valid Passport** (will be given in hopefully at the parent briefing meeting on the 10th of September)
- **GHIC / EHIC Card** (valid and in-date)
- **Sturdy Walking Boots** or waterproof shoes (we will be walking through muddy trenches)
- **Waterproof Coat** (Belgian weather is unpredictable)
- **Small Rucksack** for daytime use on the coach
- **Euro Currency** (approx €30-€50 maximum for snacks and chocolates)
- **Refillable Water Bottle**

| Time     | Activity / Location     | Details                                                                                                        |
|----------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10th Sep | Parent Briefing Meeting | 16:15 in the School Hall. Attendance is highly recommended to receive final itineraries and ask any questions. |

# Day 1: Thursday 1st October 2026

## Travel and Initial Explorations

### Introduction

Today we travel to Belgium to begin our exploration of the Ypres Salient. The itinerary is packed with important historical sites.

| Time  | Activity / Location                    | Details                                                                                                                             |
|-------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 06:15 | Departure from School                  | Travel via Jet Connect executive coach to Folkestone.                                                                               |
| 09:00 | Folkestone Eurotunnel Terminal         | Check-in and security boarding.                                                                                                     |
| 11:20 | Eurotunnel Crossing                    | Transit to Calais (clocks go forward 1 hour).                                                                                       |
| 13:00 | Depart Calais                          | Coach journey to the Ypres Salient.                                                                                                 |
| 14:30 | Essex Farm Cemetery & Dressing Station | Historical introduction to wartime medical care and Commonwealth war graves.                                                        |
| 15:15 | Langemarck German Military Cemetery    | Guided visit exploring the contrasting design of German burial sites.                                                               |
| 16:00 | Hooze Crater Museum & Trenches         | Museum visit focusing on First World War artefacts, preserved trenches, and field medicine. <a href="#">Visit official website.</a> |
| 17:45 | Arrival at Peace Village               | Accommodation check-in and safety briefing. <a href="#">View hostel details.</a>                                                    |
| 18:15 | Evening Meal                           | Dinner followed by room allocation and settling in.                                                                                 |
| 19:15 | Study & Reflection Session             | Guided review and workbook completion.                                                                                              |



# Day 2: Friday 2nd October 2026

## Immersive Battlefield Study

### Overview

Today is a full day of guided study across the Ypres Salient, concluding with the Last Post Ceremony at the Menin Gate.

| Time  | Activity / Location                     | Details                                                                                               |
|-------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 08:00 | Breakfast                               | Provided at accommodation.                                                                            |
| 09:00 | Depart for Battlefield Sites            | Board coach for full day of guided study.                                                             |
| 09:15 | The Brooding Soldier                    | Visit to the Canadian memorial at St Julien (First Gas Attack, 1915).                                 |
| 09:45 | Sanctuary Wood & Preserved Trenches     | Exploration of original trench systems (sturdy footwear advised).                                     |
| 11:30 | Supervised Lunch Stop                   | Stop in Ypres to purchase packed lunch and snacks.                                                    |
| 13:00 | Tyne Cot British Cemetery               | Guided visit to the world's largest Commonwealth war cemetery.                                        |
| 14:15 | Lijssenthoek Visitors Centre & Cemetery | Study of casualty clearing stations and battlefield medicine. <a href="#">Visit official website.</a> |
| 15:45 | Passchendaele Museum (Zonnebeke)        | Immersive museum tour and dugout experience. <a href="#">Visit official website.</a>                  |
| 17:30 | Return to Peace Village                 | Downtime and preparation for evening event.                                                           |
| 18:00 | Evening Meal                            | Dinner at accommodation.                                                                              |



# Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

## Poperinge and the Journey Home

### Departure

Our final day involves exploring the town of Poperinge, an important rest center for British soldiers, before beginning our journey home.

| Time          | Activity / Location        | Details                                                                                           |
|---------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 08:00         | Breakfast & Packing        | Breakfast, room handover, and loading coach.                                                      |
| 09:15         | Menin Gate & Ramparts Walk | Daytime study of memorial panels and walk to Ypres Ramparts Cemetery.                             |
| 10:30         | Ypres Town Square          | Supervised visit to a traditional Belgian chocolatier.                                            |
| 11:20         | Talbot House, Poperinge    | Tour of the famous British soldiers' rest house and club. <a href="#">Visit official website.</a> |
| 12:45         | Lunch in Poperinge         | Supervised lunch stop in the town centre.                                                         |
| 13:30         | Poperinge Town Hall        | Visit to preserved death cells and military justice sites.                                        |
| 14:30         | Depart for Calais          | Return journey to Eurotunnel terminal.                                                            |
| 17:50         | Eurotunnel Crossing        | Calais to Folkestone (arrives 17:30 UK time).                                                     |
| 20:00 approx. | Return to School           | Arrival back at Meoncross School for collection.                                                  |

## My Reflections: Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

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# Private T. J. Franklin

## Local Hero

### Private T. J. Franklin

**Service Number:** 8560  
**Regiment:** 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment  
**Born:** Alverstoke, Hampshire, in about 1893.

**Local Connection:** He was the son of George Franklin (an Army Pensioner and farm labourer) and Mary Ann Jane Franklin. The family lived at Chark Cottage in Stubbington, and later moved to Meadow Cottage, Chark, Lee-on-the-Solent. By 1911, Thomas was serving in Wellington Lines, Aldershot.

**Military Service & Fate:** Enlisted at Gosport. He was deployed to the Western Front in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed in action on **29th April 1915** during the Second Battle of Ypres. His battalion was holding an exposed section of the line on the Frezenberg Ridge (east of St Julien) to cover an Allied withdrawal, enduring intense German shelling and the first ever military poison gas attacks.

**Memorial Site:** Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

*Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.*

| Time          | Activity / Location      | Details                                                                 |
|---------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Home          | Stubbington Connection   | Lived at Meadow Cottage, Chark                                          |
| Memorial      | Stubbington War Memorial | Commemorated in the village center.                                     |
| Resting Place | Menin Gate, Ypres        | Killed 29th April 1915 holding an exposed line on the Frezenberg Ridge. |



# Private W. Ayling

## Local Hero

### Private W. Ayling

**Service Number:** 9330

**Rank:** Private (commemorated on the Holy Rood Memorial Tablet as a Lance Corporal, though official war records register him as a Private).

**Regiment:** 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

**Born:** About 1895 in Hindhead, Surrey.

**Local Connection:** He was the second son of Horace Ayling (a head cowman) and Annie Ayling. The family moved to Stubbington around 1907, residing in a crowded 13-person household in Stubbington Lane, where William worked as a local baker boy.

**Military Service & Fate:** Enlisted at Winchester. He crossed to France in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed by shell fire on **9th July 1915** (only a few months after his battalion comrade, Private Franklin). His company was heavily shelled and hit with trench mortars during an action to relieve captured enemy trenches north of Ypres.

**Memorial Site:** Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

*Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.*

| Time          | Activity / Location      | Details                                                      |
|---------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Home          | Stubbington Connection   | Lived in Stubbington Lane; worked as a Baker Boy             |
| Memorial      | Stubbington War Memorial | Commemorated in the village center.                          |
| Resting Place | Menin Gate, Ypres        | Killed 9th July 1915 during heavy trench mortar bombardment. |



# Private S. Muckett

## Local Hero

### Private S. Muckett

**Service Number:** 12977

**Rank:** Private (listed as a Corporal on the Holy Rood Memorial, but registered as a Private in official war records).

**Regiment:** 15th (Service) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

**Born:** 26th December 1895 at Titchfield.

**Local Connection:** He was the son of William Muckett (a farm labourer) and Elizabeth Muckett. They lived at Pound Knap, Crofton, and Brown's Farm, Stubbington, where Sydney worked as a grocer's errand boy, before relocating to Melville Gate, Stubbington. His sister Louisa Annie and brother Frank both married into the local Rye family.

**Military Service & Fate:** Enlisted at Fareham in 1914. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **20th September 1917** during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge. His battalion went over the top south of Ypres, advancing rapidly under fire to clear a German strongpoint at Java Avenue.

**Memorial Site:** Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

*Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.*

| Time          | Activity / Location       | Details                                                           |
|---------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Home          | Stubbington Connection    | Lived at Brown's Farm; worked as a Grocer's Errand Boy            |
| Memorial      | Stubbington War Memorial  | Commemorated in the village center.                               |
| Resting Place | Tyne Cot British Cemetery | Killed 20th September 1917 during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge. |



# Private A. Rye

## Local Hero

### Private A. Rye

**Service Number:** 22926  
**Regiment:** 14th Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment  
**Born:** 1897 at Forest Side, Sussex.

**Local Connection:** He was the youngest child of Charles Rye (a farm labourer) and Jane Rye. The family lived at Stroud Green, Stubbington. By 1911, Arthur was living at Lower Crabthorne, Hill Head, working as a local nurseryman. His sister Alice married Frank Muckett (brother of Private Sydney Muckett).

**Military Service & Fate:** Enlisted at Fareham. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **26th September 1917**—only nine days after his brother-in-law's brother, Sydney Muckett, was killed. His battalion attacked near the Menin Road, advancing through Tower Hamlets under heavy mist to consolidate their objectives.

**Memorial Site:** Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium, on the exact same panels as Sydney Muckett (neither body was ever recovered).

*Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.*

| Time          | Activity / Location       | Details                                     |
|---------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Home          | Stubbington Connection    | Lived at Lower Crabthorne; Nurseryman       |
| Memorial      | Stubbington War Memorial  | Commemorated in the village center.         |
| Resting Place | Tyne Cot British Cemetery | Killed 26th September 1917 at Polygon Wood. |



# Lance Corporal A. Ward

## Local Hero

### Lance Corporal A. Ward

**Service Number:** 17568

**Regiment:** 15th (Hampshire Yeomanry) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

**Born:** 1896 in Alverstoke.

**Local Connection:** He was the son of Hugh Ward (a Royal Navy Coastguard and yacht steward) and Bertha Kathleen Ward. The family lived at 6 Coastguard Cottages, Hill Head, and later Balmoral, Gosport Road, Lee-on-the-Solent. His younger brother, Horace Vivian Ward, was also killed in action.

**Military Service & Fate:** Enlisted in Portsmouth. He fought on the Western Front, in Italy, and returned to France in March 1918. He was killed in action, aged 23, on **14th October 1918**—less than a month before the Armistice. During the final Allied advance from Gheluwe towards Courtrai, Belgium, his battalion advanced through thick mist under a harassing barrage to overcome German pillboxes.

**Memorial Site:** Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

*Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.*

| Time          | Activity / Location       | Details                                           |
|---------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Home          | Stubbington Connection    | Lived at Balmoral, Gosport Road                   |
| Memorial      | Stubbington War Memorial  | Commemorated in the village center.               |
| Resting Place | Tyne Cot British Cemetery | Killed 14th October 1918 advancing in thick mist. |



# Private C. Warland

## Local Hero

### Private C. Warland

**Service Number:** T/202335

**Regiment:** 3/4th Battalion, The Queen's (Royal West Surrey) Regiment

**Born:** 1897 at Richmond, Surrey.

**Local Connection:** He was the son of John Alfred Henry Warland (a sporting journalist, author, Secretary of the Lee-on-the-Solent Golf Club, and parish councillor) and Louise Clara Warland. The family lived at Canford, Lee-on-the-Solent.

**Military Service & Fate:** Enlisted in Richmond, Surrey. He was killed in action, aged 20, on **4th October 1917** during an assault south-east of Polygon Wood. His battalion advanced across the Polygonebeek marsh to capture Juniper Trench and a blockhouse under a continuous and heavy German artillery barrage.

**Memorial Site:** Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

*Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.*

| Time          | Activity / Location       | Details                                        |
|---------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Home          | Stubbington Connection    | Lived at Canford                               |
| Memorial      | Stubbington War Memorial  | Commemorated in the village center.            |
| Resting Place | Tyne Cot British Cemetery | Killed 4th October 1917 taking Juniper Trench. |



## Reflection & Synthesis

- State who they were and where they lived.
- Describe the conditions they faced on the battlefield.
- Explain why their sacrifice, and the sacrifice of their generation, must never be forgotten.

